

Coventry University Kazakhstan

Collection Development and Information Resource Strategy

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of policy

This document identifies the principles and policies which inform the development and management of the information resource collections held by the University Library and facilitates dialogue with key stakeholders over collection development.

1.2 Strategic Context

The policy ensures that the library aligns itself with the strategic objectives of the university, supporting the development of innovative teaching, facilitating high-impact research, encouraging enterprise and innovation whilst also meeting responsibilities for globalisation and corporate social responsibility.

The library service aims to be customer driven and customer focused. This strategy recognises that the demographic of our users is wide, and their needs differ dramatically. We need to evolve our collections to consider changes and not be static in delivery options.

1.3 Guiding principles

Collection development and management:

- Is focused on the current and future information needs of the university population and the organisations corporate strategy.
- It is responsive to the changing needs of a diverse range of library customers and is actively seeking to identify and promote material that diversifies the collection and addresses power and privilege and a social conscience at all levels.
- Provides a collective resource for CUK Education Group and purchases material that benefits the entire university community.
- Takes account of the quality, value for money and accessibility of information resources
- Prioritizes e-format to facilitate availability and access
- Works in partnership with academics to anticipate demand and understand the resource requirements of the faculties. This is dependent upon the provision of timely and accurate information as to the needs and involvement of the library in course development and module creations.
- It is limited by the annual Content Budget provided by the university.

- We will continue to explore new technologies and initiatives that positively impact the student experience of accessing resources in the library.

2. Collection Development

2.1 Meeting User Information Needs

- Highest priority is given to the acquisition of material identified on module reading lists.
- The library operates a “digital first” policy of resources provision
- Purchase of print will be agreed only where it can bring demonstrable benefit to the student experience and where the e-model cannot meet their needs (e.g. due to licensing restrictions or there is no electronic version or comparable text available in e-format)
- The library will make every effort to purchase the information resources requested by the academic staff. If the library is unable to provide the items requested in a reasonable format or within budget constraints, then staff will be informed as soon as possible, and alternative solutions discussed
- The library will also purchase items that add value to the collection by offering diverse perspectives or that support the development and well-being of the community, offer a global perspective and recognise the international reputation of the university.
- The library seeks to empower its users to select content through the library catalog.
- A core list of journals and databases for each subject area is agreed between the Academic Liaison Librarian and relevant academic staff. These are selected based on:
 - Relevance and scope of subject content
 - Value for money
- Requests that cannot be immediately fulfilled will be recorded and reviewed periodically considering cost, demand and any budget flexibility
- The library works in partnership with the academic staff ensure the provision of appropriate resources that offer value for money and enhance the student experience

2.1.1 Students on franchised courses

It is expected that partner organisations running a Coventry University Kazakhstan course under franchise will be the main provider of library services to support the tutors and students. All students on franchised courses have access to a limited subset of the library's collections of electronic resources. This is subject to publisher licenses and charges and can be subject to change.

2.1.2 Controversial materials

Coventry University Library supports the reader's right to choose. Intellectual freedom is an essential value in the life and work of any university.

Accordingly, the Library purchases materials that represent a wide variety of viewpoints for the purpose of academic study. The library does not censor materials based on the author or subject's race, gender, sexuality, creed, nationality, religion, political party, social affiliations, beliefs or opinions. The inclusion in our collections of works that some groups might find offensive does not constitute endorsement or promotion of the works in question.

2.1.3 Excluded material

The library will not purchase the following:

- General-purpose applications software which enables the processing and manipulation of information rather than conveying information in its own right
- Subject-specific applications software

2.2 Procurement

The library staff are responsible for acquiring all purchased information resources for the CUK Library.

2.2.1 Donations

Donations of material to the library are accepted at the library's discretion and without obligation. They are normally only added to stock if they relate to the teaching or research activity of the university, fill gaps in our existing collection, or if they are of local significance. They will be subject to the same criteria as items purchased by the library.

Once donated, all items become the property of the library, which reserves the right to dispose of unwanted material.

2.2.2 Electronic resources

The library will prioritise access to electronic subscriptions for e-books, e-journals and databases as a means of widening access to materials, as a cost-effective alternative to printed collections, to facilitate information retrieval and enrich the user experience, and to facilitate multi-user access. The library does not seek to license resources for any one specific group of students but works on the basis that resources should be available to all members. The selection criteria are the same as for print, plus:

- Licence and copyright conditions: the flexibility of the license with regard to authentication mechanisms, single/multiuser access, off-campus usage and usage by non-university members.
- Extent of access to back files and post subscription cancellation access

2.2.3 Open Access e-journals

The library supports the global open access movement which aims to make scholarly publications freely available to all who might benefit. Such content facilitates scholarly communication and provides cost-effective access to information. The library will seek to promote use of these resources as part of library collections where they can provide a dependable and free alternative to expensive e-journal “bundle” subscriptions.

2.2.4 Media Collection

The Media Collection comprises audio-visual, audio & multimedia resources across all subject disciplines within the university. The key constituents of the collection are:

- The licensed off-air recordings, which are available through bob wherever possible.
- Multimedia items on CD/DVD-ROM are shelved with the book stock. Responsibility for the acquisition of multimedia & CD items lies with the Academic Liaison Team.
- Microfilm & microfiche have been retained under guidance from academic liaison librarians as an archive.

2.3 Special collections

2.3.1 Archives

The library seeks to develop or acquire new archival collections as outlined in its archive collections policy.

2.3.2 Theses and dissertations

University regulations stipulate that e-only copies of PhD and Master's degree theses will be stored. Undergraduate and Postgraduate taught course dissertations are not accepted.

The library can apply any embargo periods stipulated regarding a thesis (e.g. due to commercial confidentiality). The library will also retrospectively digitise the most heavily requested paper theses and make these available.

3. Collection Management

3.1 Organisation

The physical collections of the CUK library (printed texts and journals) are organised by Library of Congress Classification. The libraries operate a policy of open access to collections, apart from some material considered to be of value, prone to vandalism or theft, valuable art and design material, and material requiring supervision because of age, value or of a potentially explicit material not deemed appropriate for the open shelves

3.2 Withdrawal of stock

All library collections are provided as working collections to support the current teaching, learning, and research activity of the university. A policy of relegation and withdrawal aims to maintain the currency and coherence of the collections and allows the collections to be accommodated within the space available.

3.3 Monitoring and review

The library monitors and reviews the usage of the information resources collections in all formats to ensure that expenditure on resources is being targeted appropriately and reflects the changing requirements of teaching, learning and research.